

## Authors Lab — Investor One-Pager

A Spike Island Studios Venture

### THE PROBLEM

Writing a book is one of the hardest creative endeavours a person can undertake — and the professional editorial support that makes the difference between a manuscript and a publishable book is expensive, slow, and largely inaccessible. The global self-publishing market is growing fast, but the tools available to independent authors are either generic writing apps or expensive human editorial services costing thousands of pounds. There is nothing in between that provides genuine, professional-grade editorial intelligence at scale.

### THE SOLUTION

Authors Lab is an AI-powered editorial and publishing studio — a complete platform that takes an author from first draft to published book, with professional-grade support at every stage. It is not a writing assistant. It is a full editorial team, available on demand, at a fraction of traditional cost.

The platform currently features three live AI editors:

- Alex — structural and developmental editing
- Sam — line and copy editing
- Jordan — proofreading and consistency

Releasing in phased stages:

- Wright — AI ideas incubator and first-draft manuscript generator
- Taylor — writing coach and style development
- Publishing Hub — end-to-end self-publishing workflow
- Kai and Riley — specialist editorial roles
- Marketing Hub — author platform and book launch support
- Design Studio — professional book cover design

Each release is a new revenue beat and a new reason for existing users to upgrade.

### TRACTION (Live Production Database)

- 11 beta authors currently on platform (grandfathered pricing)
- 272 chapters processed
- 4,061 editorial chat messages
- 789 editorial findings generated
- B2B imprint demo booked: September, with a Blair Partnership-backed imprint

All figures are sourced directly from the live production database — not projections.

## BUSINESS MODEL

Self-serve subscription tiers (monthly / annual):

- Starter: £7 / £10
- Author: £13 / £19
- Pro: £27 / £39
- One-time editorial pass: £119
- Imprint (B2B white-label): £250–£1,000/month

Revenue motions:

1. Self-serve author funnel — individual writers subscribing and upgrading as new features release
2. B2B imprint channel — publishing imprints licensing the platform for their author rosters

Unit economics: a full developmental editorial pass costs approximately £0.40–£0.80 to deliver. Prompt caching reduces input costs by 90%. Contribution margins are exceptional at this price point.

## MARKET OPPORTUNITY

The global self-publishing market is large, growing, and underserved by professional-grade tools. Authors Lab sits at the intersection of the creator economy, AI productivity tools, and the publishing industry — three of the fastest-growing segments in the digital economy.

## THE FOUNDERS

Carl Lyons — the Strategist. Founder, published author, and negotiation specialist. Background in principled negotiation, behavioural psychology, and conscious business. Brings deep understanding of the author's experience and the publishing industry from the inside.

Paul Lyons — the Systems Architect. Technology entrepreneur and AI builder. Designed and engineered the Authors Lab platform end-to-end — without a single hired software engineer. 20+ years across film, television, and music.

Authors Lab is a venture of Spike Island Studios — a London-based AI venture studio founded by Paul and Carl Lyons. Spike Island Studios builds AI platforms that solve real professional problems, partners with industry experts to commercialise them, and builds each into an independent, fundable entity.

## THE ASK

Raising: £350,000

Structure: £250,000 SEIS + £100,000 EIS

Dilution: 12–15%

Post-money valuation: £2.3M–£2.9M

Use of funds: Platform development (Wright, Taylor, Publishing Hub, Design Studio), marketing launch, B2B imprint channel development, 12–15 months runway

SEIS advance assurance: in progress.

## WHAT SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE AT 18 MONTHS

- Full editorial suite live (Wright, Taylor, Publishing Hub, Marketing Hub, Design Studio)
- Self-serve subscriber base established with measurable monthly recurring revenue
- B2B imprint channel generating recurring licence income
- Platform positioned for Series A or strategic acquisition by a major publishing group

## CONTACT

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